

Uses



The radium paint in this clock makes the numbers glow green-blue in the dark.



PIERRE AND MARIE CURIE

Radium was discovered in 1898 by Marie and Pierre Curie. They found that uranium ores produced more radioactivity than expected from samples of uranium. They realized another radioactive metal was present and named it radium.



This vial contains a liquid called radium chloride.

Vials for radium treatment

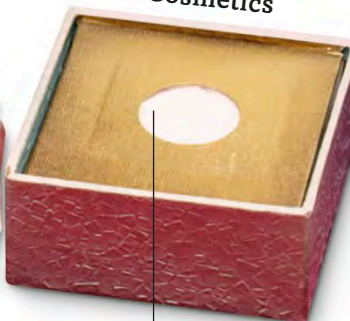
Pocket watch with a luminous dial

This machine from the early 20th century mixed radium into water, which was thought to make it healthier to drink.

Cosmetics



Skin lotions containing radium were common in the 1920s.



Radium face powder was once thought to be good for the skin.



Radium emanator

glow in the dark, were created using radium. People working with this paint often became ill, especially with cancer, because the radiation produced by radium damages DNA. Nevertheless, until the 1940s, many people thought radium's radioactivity made them

stronger, not weaker. They injected themselves with **vials containing a radium compound**, believing it gave them an energy boost. They also thought that creams and **cosmetics** with radium in them made the skin healthier, even though they did exactly the opposite.